THE RESTLESS FOUNDER / FREE GUIDE

The ADHD Founder's Guide to AI

How to stop being the operator of your own life and start being the director.

Written for the brain that knows exactly what to do and still can't start.

The knowing-doing gap, in one page.

You can see exactly what needs doing. You have the skill to do it. And still, sometimes, you can't get from one to the other.

That gap is not laziness and it is not a lack of discipline. It lives between a thought and the first physical action, and for an ADHD brain that step is the heaviest one in the whole task. Starting asks you to make a dozen small decisions at once: where to begin, how long it will take, what done looks like. When that is too much, the task sits there, and the guilt grows around it.

What does not work

Pushing harder. Planning for longer. Waiting until you feel ready. Each one adds weight to the very step you are trying to lift.

What does

Taking the decisions away. Make the first step so small and so clear that there is nothing left to dread, and let something else do the deciding.

That something else is AI. Not as a magic fix, and not as a replacement for the support you already have, but as a patient, tireless partner that is never judging you for the state of your thoughts. This guide shows you how to use it for that, in the order that works.

Rule of the whole guide: you never have to start from a clean page.

The five-minute-step ramble.

Use this one whenever something has been sitting on your list for days. It takes about two minutes and it always ends with one thing to do.

1. **Pick the one thing you have been avoiding.** Not the biggest, just the one that keeps coming back into your head.

2. **Ramble it to an AI for sixty seconds.** Use voice dictation if you can. Do not tidy it, do not order it. The mess is the input.

3. **Ask for the first five-minute step and nothing else.** Paste the prompt below before you start talking.

4. **Do only that step.** When it is done, say done and ask for the next one. You are allowed to stop after three.

PASTE THIS FIRST

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I have ADHD and I am avoiding a task. I am about to talk about it out loud and it will be messy. Do not give me a plan. Ask me three short questions to find out what is really stopping me, wait for my answers, then give me the single smallest first step that takes five minutes or less and needs no decision. Write that step as one sentence starting with a verb. Then stay quiet until I tell you it is done.
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Why it works: the task was never the problem. The first decision was. This prompt removes it.

AI is the team you always needed.

You do not need more discipline. You need people around you who catch what falls and sort what is messy. Here are the five jobs AI can take over today.

01 CAPTURE	**Catch the messy thoughts.** The idea in the shower, the worry at midnight, the half-sentence from a call. Talk it into an AI the second it appears, so it lives somewhere other than your head.
02 TASKS	**Turn the mess into tasks.** Ask for a short list in plain language: what to do, in what order, and what can wait. You decide what stays. The sorting is no longer your job.
03 MORNING	**Start with a ramble, not a to-do list.** Spend two minutes talking through the day. Have the AI hand back the three things that matter and one place to begin.
04 EMAIL	**Triage your inbox.** Paste the messages in. Get back which ones need you, which can be answered in one line, and drafts you can edit in your own voice.
05 DIRECT	**Be the director, not the operator.** You decide the outcome and the standard. AI does the first draft, the research, the formatting and the follow-up. Your job is to say yes, no, or closer.

Director, not operator. That is the whole shift.

Five prompts to paste today.

1 BRAIN DUMP TO TASKS

Here is everything in my head right now, unfiltered: [talk or paste]. Turn it into a task list in three groups: Do today, Do this week, Not now. Keep each task to one line starting with a verb. Do not add anything I did not say. Ask me if something is unclear.

2 MORNING RAMBLE

I will ramble about my day. Listen, then give me: the three things that matter most, the one I should do first, and one thing I am probably overloading myself with that I can drop. Keep it under 100 words. Be kind and be direct.

3 EMAIL TRIAGE

Here are my unread emails: [paste]. Sort them into: Needs me today, Can be answered in one line, Can wait, Ignore. For the first two, draft a reply in a warm, short, plain style. Do not invent facts. Flag anything you are unsure about.

Direct it. Then close the day.

4 THE DIRECTOR BRIEF

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I am the director and you are my team. The outcome I want is: [one sentence]. The standard is: [what good looks like]. Give me a first draft I can react to, not questions. After the draft, list the three decisions only I can make. Wait for my answer.
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5 THE SHUTDOWN

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Here is what I got done today: [list]. Here is what is still open: [list]. Write me a short note for tomorrow morning with the one place to start and anything I should not forget. Tell me one thing I did well today.
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Where to start, today

1. **Run the five-minute-step ramble** on the one thing you have been avoiding.

2. **Tomorrow morning, use prompt 2.** Two minutes, no list.

3. **Tonight, use prompt 5.** Close the day so tomorrow starts with somewhere to go.

Not medical advice. This is a working system that sits alongside whatever support you already use. Make it yours: change the words until they sound like you.

This is not a character flaw. It is a brain that was never properly explained to you.